

| Techcom<br>DSC 512X plus | Sony<br>Cyber-shot DSC S40 | Techcom<br>DSC 524X plus |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|
|--------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|

|                                        |                                                  |                                        |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 10.8 x 5.6 x 3.8                       | 9.9 x 5.2 x 3.4                                  | 9.9 x 5.5 x 3.5                        |
| 140                                    | 184                                              | 140                                    |
| 2560 x 1920                            | 2304 x 1728                                      | 2560 x 1920                            |
| 5.1                                    | 4                                                | 5.1                                    |
| 35~105                                 | 32~96                                            | 35~105                                 |
| 3x                                     | 3x                                               | 3x                                     |
| 5x                                     | 3x                                               | 5x                                     |
| ✓                                      | ✓                                                | ✓                                      |
| ✗                                      | ✗                                                | ✓                                      |
| 10                                     | 11                                               | 10                                     |
| 2                                      | 1.5                                              | 2.4                                    |
| 110000                                 | 77000                                            | 110000                                 |
| ✓ / 4                                  | ✓ / 5                                            | ✓ / 4                                  |
| ✓ / 7                                  | ✓ / 5                                            | ✓ / 7                                  |
| 8 ~ 1/1000                             | 30 ~ 1/2000                                      | 8 ~ 1/1000                             |
| M.S, Spot                              | M.S                                              | M.S, Spot                              |
| ✓ (2~10)                               | ✓ / 10                                           | ✓ (2~10)                               |
| ✓ / ✗                                  | ✓ / ✗                                            | ✓ / ✗                                  |
| SD + internal                          | MS / MS pro                                      | SD + internal                          |
| 32                                     | 32                                               | 32                                     |
| ✓                                      | ✗                                                | ✓                                      |
| USB                                    | USB                                              | USB                                    |
| ✓                                      | ✓                                                | ✓                                      |
| AA                                     | AA                                               | AA                                     |
| ✗                                      | ✗                                                | ✗                                      |
| ✓                                      | ✓                                                | ✓                                      |
| Carry pouch, strap,<br>video out cable | Strap, carry case, USB<br>cable, video out cable | Carry pouch, strap,<br>video out cable |

|      |      |      |
|------|------|------|
| 3    | 3.5  | 3.25 |
| 3    | 3.5  | 3    |
| 2.75 | 3.25 | 3    |
| 3.25 | 3    | 3.25 |
| 3.25 | 3    | 3.5  |

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
| ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
|---|---|---|

|      |      |     |
|------|------|-----|
| 3    | 3    | 3   |
| 3.5  | 3.5  | 3.5 |
| 3.25 | 3.5  | 3.5 |
| 3    | 3.25 | 3   |
| 3.25 | 3.25 | 3   |
| 3    | 3.25 | 3   |

|   |   |      |
|---|---|------|
| 3 | 3 | 3.25 |
| 3 | 3 | 2.35 |

|       |       |       |
|-------|-------|-------|
| 25.14 | 24.92 | 27.76 |
| 22.50 | 23.18 | 22.14 |
| 6.57  | 6.56  | 6.18  |
| 54.21 | 54.66 | 56.08 |
| 7,990 | 8,000 | 8,490 |



+ Good image detail  
- Slightly over-rich colours



+ Nice button layout  
- Mediocre performance, lacks build quality



+ Good image quality, decent build quality  
- Over-rich colours

**BEST BUY**  
**digit**  
SEPTEMBER 2006



**Sony W-50**  
**Fine Shooting needs the best shooter**

The largest zoomer here was the Kodak V610, with an optical zoom of 10x, excellent for its size. The Canon A700 was the runner up as far as zooming capabilities go with a 6x optical zoom. The other models were pretty much on par with 3x optical zooms. Two Kodak models—the V570 and the V610—sport something unique: they had two lenses! We did a little digging around: it turned out that one of the lenses is a wide-angle, and the other is the zoom lens. Kodak claims this offers the best of both worlds. The trick is that both the lenses don't work simultaneously. With the V570, a 5-megapixel camera, each lens has a CCD sensor that offers 5-megapixel resolution. During normal shooting, the wide-angle lens is used, and while zooming, the camera seamlessly switches to the zoom lens.

## PERFORMANCE Entry-Level Cameras

We'll do this brand by brand; we randomly picked the Premier range first. Quality-wise, the outputs of the DC6370 and DC5370 were nearly identical, with the higher megapixel rating becoming slightly noticeable only when the image is enlarged and viewed at its maximum size. The dearth of pixels will not be noticeable in a 4" x 6" printout, for example. The overall tonal balance was well-maintained by both cameras. This is noticeable as the colours are quite natural, and not artificially bright. The lower-end DS-5082 offers a much softer image, without a lot of detail, and noticeable graininess. The DS-3088-S shows up graininess that is noticeable for the most part, and particularly when the image is viewed at 100 per cent. It loses out on colour reproduction; the image looks rather faded. This is understandable taking into consideration its diminutive megapixel count (3.2 MP).

One look at the Techcom duo will redefine the meaning of the phrase "rich colour". While rich is generally a good thing, the 512-X and 524-X overdo the colours, and the image looks

Two Kodak models—the V570 and the V610—sport two lenses. One of them is a wide-angle, while the other is a zoom lens